We read the case, ran the numbers twice, and honestly we are voting to wait. Not forever, and not because we lack ambition. The arithmetic simply does not work yet.

Right now our contribution margin is minus 31 rupees per order once cold-chain and packaging costs are counted (the case states minus 7, but that line excludes packaging; we added it back). At 1.2 million orders a month this is a 3.7 crore hole every month. Expansion would place three more such holes on the map.

A tier-2 dark store still carries cold-chain capex of 45 lakh. Our vendor quoted rates 19% higher outside metro routes because container runs are thinner. That single line pushes store break-even to roughly 1,100 orders a day, higher than any tier-2 benchmark we located.

Fix the core first: renegotiate the cold-chain contract, lift basket size by bundling staples, and take minus 31 to minus 5. Six months of honest cost work, then a re-look. If margins still have not improved by the second review, the decision has been made for us anyway.

Two quarters. That is the whole pitch.